

Moving-In Condition Report & Rights Checklist — Northern Territory

Get this right on day one — it protects your bond for the entire tenancy.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Before You Sign the Lease

- ☐ ☐ **Know your tenancy is governed by the Residential Tenancies Act 1999 (NT).**
- ☐ ☐ **Know rent bidding and unilateral rent increases between offer and signing are prohibited** — if the rent you're offered differs from what you agreed at inspection, that's a red flag worth raising.
- ☐ ☐ **Ask about cyclone/wet-season preparedness** if you're in Darwin or the Top End — window/door seals, drainage, and general storm readiness are genuinely relevant liveability questions in the NT.

Section 2 — The Condition Report Itself

- ☐ ☐ **Request the entry condition report** if not automatically provided.
- ☐ ☐ **Complete your own section thoroughly**, room by room.
- ☐ ☐ **Photograph everything**, especially existing wear, damage, or imperfections.
- ☐ ☐ **Note existing issues explicitly.**
- ☐ ☐ **Test everything that should work:** taps, toilets, switches, power points, stovetop, air conditioning (genuinely important given the NT's climate), and any included appliances.
- ☐ ☐ **Submit your condition report within the required timeframe.**
- ☐ ☐ **Keep a copy for yourself** — you'll need it again at the end of your lease.

Section 3 — Ongoing Rights During Your Tenancy

- ☐ ☐ **Know the specific conditions required for a rent increase.** All of the following must apply: your tenancy agreement has a condition allowing rent increases; the agreement notes the calculation method; you're given at least **30 days' notice**; the increase doesn't occur within the **first 6 months** of your agreement; and it happens **no more than once every 6 months**.
- ☐ ☐ **Know you can challenge an excessive rent increase.** You can apply to NTCAT, which will assess whether the rate is excessive compared to market rent for similar properties.
- ☐ ☐ **Know about rent decrease rights too** — if services have changed, or if the rent has become excessive relative to the market, you can negotiate directly with your landlord or apply to the Commissioner of Tenancies for a rental review if negotiations don't work.
- ☐ ☐ **Request repairs in writing** — this creates a paper trail if a dispute later needs to go to NTCAT.
- ☐ ☐ **Know rent arrears process timing.** If your rent is more than 14 days overdue, your landlord can serve a notice giving you 7 days to pay before applying to NTCAT to end the tenancy.

Section 4 — Red Flags at Move-In

- ☐ ☐ **A condition report with suspiciously few noted issues** on an older or clearly lived-in property.
- ☐ ☐ **Being pressured to sign before receiving the condition report or properly inspecting.**
- ☐ ☐ **A rent figure different from what was advertised or discussed at inspection** — this may breach the ban on rent bidding/gazumping.
- ☐ ☐ **Non-functioning air conditioning or storm-related seals/drainage issues** — genuinely material in the NT's climate.

Quick Reference — NT Tenant Rights & Key Facts

Requirement	Detail
Governing legislation	Residential Tenancies Act 1999 (NT)
Rent bidding/gazumping	Prohibited
Rent increase conditions	Agreement clause required, 30 days' notice, none in first 6 months, max once per 6 months
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent
Rent arrears process	14 days overdue → 7-day notice → NTCAT application
Dispute resolution	NTCAT

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